HALCYON REEF OBSERVATORY · 2026 FIELD SEASON

The reef is recovering, unevenly

Results of 212 survey dives across five monitored sites, March to September

The season in three numbers

+5.2

points of live coral cover, on average

4 of 5

monitored sites are recovering

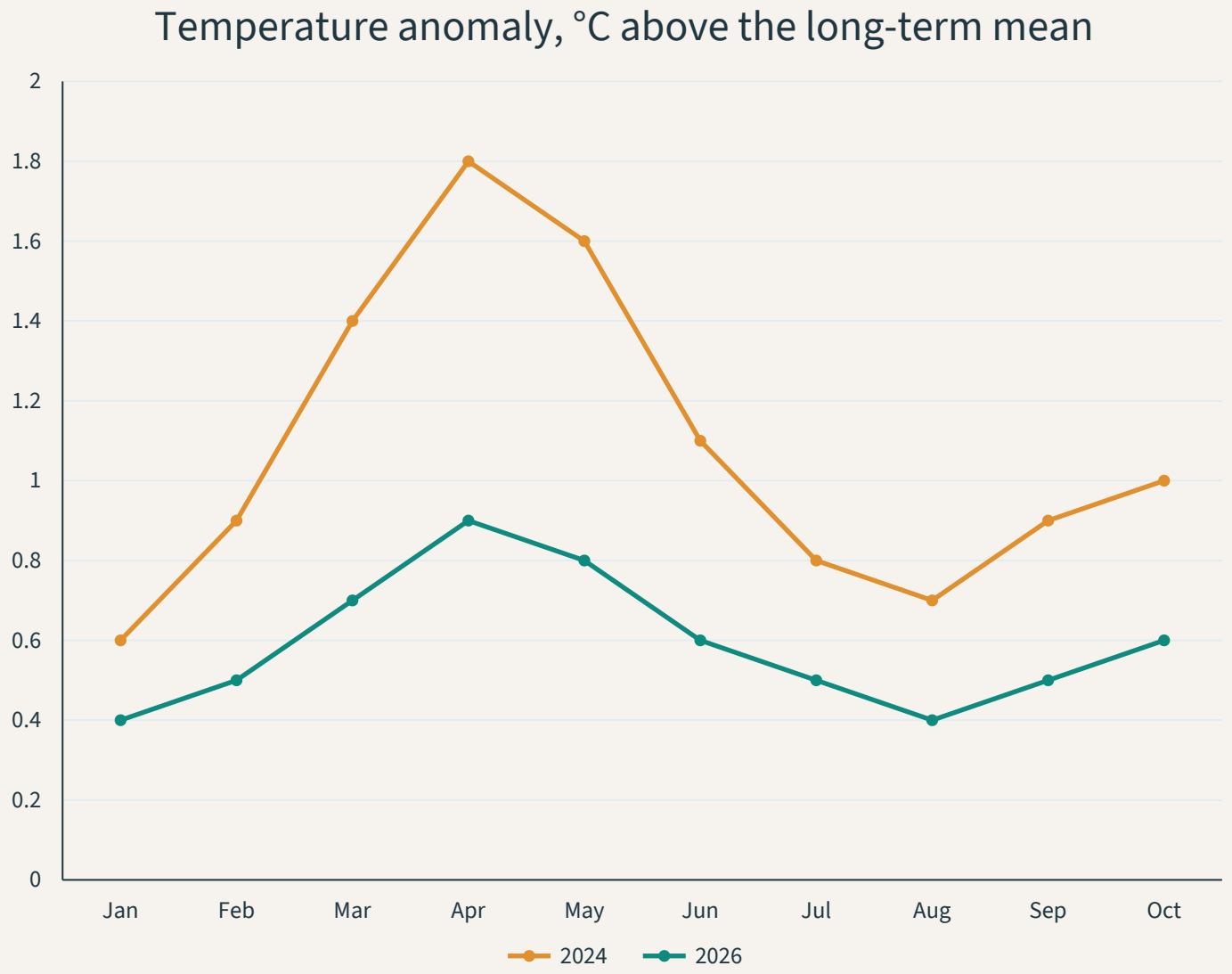
+1

point at the Eastern Wall, which has stalled

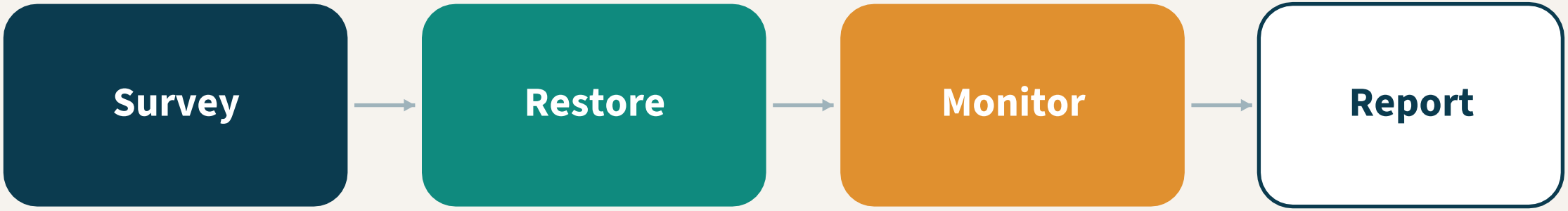
Cooler water, faster recovery

Sea-surface temperature stayed within one degree of the long-term mean for all of 2026.

In 2024 it exceeded that threshold for five consecutive months, which triggered the bleaching event.



The plan for 2027



Repeat all five transects each spring and autumn.

Outplant 6,000 nursery fragments on the Eastern Wall.

Log temperature hourly on the boundary current.

Brief the trustees each quarter.

Budget request **$480,000** for Eastern Wall restoration